

such as Courtallam Waterfalls, Muttom Bay, Thirparappu Falls, Vathalmalai, Muthupettai Mangrove forest, Muthukuda, and Pichvaram Boathouse. Renovation and construction projects are also being carried out, such as the establishment of a "Nandavanam" at ECR, Chennai, a world-class Jallikattu arena at Alanganalur, Madurai, and the renovation of Poompuhar Heritage City.

The department has actively participated in various cultural events and tourism festivals, both within Tamil Nadu and internationally. The Indian Dance Festival, Pongal Festival, and Chennai Sangamam – Namma Ooru Thiruvizha were celebrated with great enthusiasm. Tamil Nadu Tourism sponsored events like the Tamil Nadu International Balloon Festival and won numerous accolades. The Tamil Nadu Tourism Development Corporation (TTDC) has undertaken various upgradation works.

ADI DRAVIDAR WELFARE, HILL TRIBES AND BONDED LABOUR WELFARE

The Tamil Nadu Government has established the Tamil Nadu Adi Dravidar and Tribal Welfare Commission to protect the rights of Adi Dravidar and Scheduled Tribes. Seven communities have been grouped under the name 'Devendirakula Velalar'. Model villages with caste-free burial grounds will receive Rs 10 lakh for infrastructure improvement. Ethnographic research and cultural documentation for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups is ongoing. Assistance to various welfare boards has been enhanced. Training and scholarships are being provided to help students qualify for educational institutions abroad.

AGRICULTURE

In support of Kurvai paddy cultivation in the Cauvery Delta districts of Tamil Nadu, the Honourable Chief Minister inaugurated the Mettur Dam on 12th June. Additionally, a Kurvai Cultivation Package Scheme was announced with an allocation of Rs.61.09 Crore. The target for Kurvai paddy cultivation in 2021 was 3.50 Lakh acres, but it exceeded expectations with an area of 4.90 Lakh acres being cultivated. In 2022, there was a remarkable achievement in paddy cultivation during the Kuruvai season. The Mettur Dam was opened for irrigation 19 days earlier than the usual date, on 24th May. As a result, 5.36 Lakh acres of paddy cultivation took place during the year. Efforts have been made to promote the growth of millets. Two schemes, namely the "Sustainable Cotton Cultivation Mission" and "National Food Security Mission - Cotton," were implemented to increase the area, production, and productivity of cotton.

ENVIRONMENT AND FOREST

The Government has established the Marine Elite Force, the first of its kind in the country. Two units have been set up in the Gulf of Mannar Biosphere Reserve. This initiative aims to enhance marine conservation efforts. Tamil Nadu has secured the designation of 13 new Ramsar sites, bringing the total to 14. The Guindy National Park is being remodelled as a Children's Nature Park. Additionally, the first Dugong Conservation Reserve in India has been established in the Gulf of Mannar and Palk Bay areas. Another notable accomplishment is the declaration of the Kadavur Slender Loris Sanctuary, the first such in the country. The Forest Department's efforts have gained international recognition through "The Elephant Whisperers," a documentary film that won an Oscar award. The Government has expressed its intent to obtain the Blue Flag certification for 10 more beaches within the next five years, with a total budget of Rs. 100 crore. Furthermore, Tamil Nadu has become the first state in India to launch a Climate Change Mission with a budget of Rs 500 crore.

ENERGY

The Tamil Nadu Generation and Distribution Corporation Limited (TANGEDCO) established one lakh agriculture service connections at a cost of Rs 803 crore in 2021-22. In the following year, 50,000 general category services were implemented, at a cost of Rs 816 crore, along with 589 services under the special priority category. The total installed capacity of Tamil Nadu has been increased to 34,706 MW from 32,595 MW, and the TANGEDCO grid achieved a record daily consumption of 400.881 MU on 13th April 2023, with a maximum demand of 18,667 MW on 12th April 2023. Renewable power generation has seen remarkable progress, with all-time highs of 5,689 MW of wind generation on 3rd July 2022 and 4,866 MW of solar generation on 26th February 2023. Moreover, 2,028 MW of solar power has been added to the grid in the 2021-22 period, bringing the total installed capacity to 6,539 MW.

LAW & ORDER

In the past two years, the Tamil Nadu Police Department has accomplished significant milestones. Operation rowdy vettai resulted in the detention of 3,949 history sheeted criminals under the Goondas Act. Operation Ganja vettai led to the detention of 13,491 ganja peddlers and the seizure of 24 tons of ganja. The establishment of new Commissionerates in Avadi and Tambaram has enhanced the security of Chennai, making it a safe city for women and children. The Tamil Nadu Police received the prestigious President's Colour, and the Chief Minister received it from the Vice-President of India.

HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE

The Health and Family Welfare Department has

